

1. Quoting GitHub Changelog

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-14T22:43:35+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/14/github-changeling/#atom-everything>

Dependabot now waits until a new release has been available on its registry for at least three days before opening a version update pull request. This cooldown is now the default and requires no configuration. ? GitHub Changelog , embracing dependency cooldowns Tags: dependency-cooldowns , packaging , security , github

2. simonw/pedalican

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-14T22:29:45+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/14/pedalican/#atom-everything>

simonw/pedalican Clearly I wasn't paying attention when these were first announced back in May, but today I accidentally activated a "pet" in Codex Desktop - a little animated robot, reminiscent of Clippy - and then learned you can create your own. So I did, and now I have a cute little pelican on a bicycle bouncing around my desktop giving me updates on my Codex tasks. Your browser does not support HTML5 video. The most interesting thing about this process was watching how the custom pet was created. I told it I wanted a custom pet that was a pelican riding a bicycle and GPT-5.6 Sol xhigh did the rest of the work, using several rounds with gpt-image-2 to generate the necessary sprite assets. I had it make extensive notes and record all of the intermediary steps . My GitHub repo includes every generated image and combined sprite sheet, plus GIFs for each of the animation loops such as this one, called waving.gif : That GIF was compiled from a single image generated by gpt-image-2 that looked like this: And that image was created by executing this prompt against the initial generated character reference image , which was created with this prompt , which has this structure: Create o...

3. lobste.rs is now running on SQLite

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-14T19:44:11+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/14/lobsters-sqlite/#atom-everything>

lobste.rs is now running on SQLite Community site Lobsters has been planning a migration away from MariaDB since August 2018 - originally targeting PostgreSQL, but last year they decided to investigate SQLite instead. This weekend they completed the migration, and now consider it stable enough that it looks like this is the permanent architecture for the site going forward: SQLite seems to have passed with flying colors: cpu usage is down, memory usage is down, site seems to be snappier at least for me, 1/2 the vps cost once mariadb vps is taken down The Lobsters Rails application now runs on a single VPS, with a primary content SQLite database file that's around 3.8GB. There's also a 1.1GB cache database, a 218MB queue database, and a still growing 555MB rack_attack database used by the Rack::Attack middleware for blocking and throttling abusive requests. There are plenty more details in both the linked thread and this SQLite migration PR by Thomas Dziedzic, which added 735 lines and removed 593 lines across 30 commits and 188 files. That PR built on top of previous PRs #1705 , #1871 , and #1924 . This is a really useful case study, and a great reminder that you can get a whole l...

4. Microsoft Patches a Record 570 Security Flaws

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 19:22:42 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/07/microsoft-patches-a-record-570-security-flaws/>

Microsoft Corp. today released software updates to plug at least 570 security holes in its Windows operating systems and other software, almost triple the number of vulnerabilities the software giant fixed in its record-smashing Patch Tuesday release last month. Microsoft attributed the burgeoning patch counts to vulnerability discoveries aided by artificial intelligence.

5. What does "playing politics" mean for software engineers?

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/playing-politics/>

Software engineers are often told to "start playing politics", but most engineers have no idea what that means. Their reference point for "playing politics" comes from fiction like Game of Thrones. Are they supposed to raise an army and depose the CEO, or poison each other at team lunch? Should they book Zoom calls with each other and plot schemes? All of that is obviously ridiculous. In terms of Game of Thrones, software engineers are not lords and ladies. We're the soldiers and workers of the realm. So you should think about "playing politics" in the way a castle guard would, not one of the major players. The castle guard are not going around poisoning people or forming coalitions between the great powers. They are largely keeping their heads down. But in order to do that, they have to stay aware of the political currents, or they're liable to do something catastrophically stupid: for instance, making an enemy of a powerful courtier, or arresting somebody who's on an important mission for the king. Given that, the basic principles of playing politics are something like this: Be aware of who's powerful and who's not At all costs, avoid making powerful enemies Help powerful people...

6. They Prefer the App

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 22:35:36 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/they-prefer-the-app>

I like building websites. But in some circles, I might as well say that I like to drive to the forest before sunrise, chop down a tree, load it in my trunk, and gather some dry wood as well, then drive back before first light. All this just to use the wood to start a fire and cook breakfast for my family in our high-rise apartment. It makes no sense. There is a large class of apps that could be replaced by a simple website, especially those made for schools that only present information. The worst part is that in those apps, most of the things we take for granted on the web are blocked. You can't copy and paste, you can't open a link in a new app, and you have to update the entire app just to get new information. For someone like me, who never updates an app until it's necessary, I usually end up with broken applications. But when I complain, I'm usually alone in those circles, because no one seems to know what a website is. The more I explain, the more I sound like a character from the 90s explaining how cool email is. They don't know what a website is. Check their phones, they have a thousand apps. The last time I blogged about just using websites, several people pointed out t...

7. [Sponsor] Paper

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-14T05:02:00Z

Link: https://paper.design/?utm_source=df

Paper is a professional design tool where every layer is real HTML and CSS. Your design is already code, which means fewer handoffs and fewer translations between what you design and what ships. Paper works both ways: code to design, and design to code. Connect any agent through MCP and it can read and edit your designs. Or use Paper Snapshot to capture your live site as editable layers and make new iterations. Agents handle the tedious work so you can focus on your craft and the decisions that matter. Try Paper at paper.design.

8. Sam Altman and Elon Musk Argue Over Who's Running the Bigger Scam

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-12T17:45:57Z

Link: <https://x.com/sama/status/2075982617976230043>

Elon Musk, linking to his own tweet from March that "Sam Altman is super good at scamming": He takes scamming to a whole new level Sam Altman: homeboy you're the one selling public market investors on short-term space datacenters Musk: We start flying them next year. Maybe you can come see them if your parole officer approves. After stealing an open source AI charity, you then stole all of Apple's phone technology! Wow. What do you plan for an encore? That's tough to beat. (All spelling, capitalization, and punctuation sic.) These are two of the CEOs of the most valuable companies on the planet. Say what you want about it, but Musk's Twitter/X is like nothing else that's ever existed. Screenshot of the thread for posterity, and an XCancel link

for those icked by X itself. ?

9. Lunacy ? Jeff Halter?s Lunatic Fringe Player

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-12T17:19:36Z

Link: <https://morphing.cloud/lunacy/>

After linking to Stacks , his remarkable new modern HyperCard player, I made the terrible mistake of clicking around the rest of Jeff Halter?s website, and fell upon Lunacy: Created by Ben Haller and released in the early ?90s as part of the Macintosh More After Dark software package, Lunatic Fringe was unique among screensavers in that it was not just a passive animation to watch, but an interactive game! Toggling the Caps Lock key while the screensaver was running popped you into a space shooter where you could fly around, collect power-ups, and blast a variety of baddies all in pursuit of a high score. It was a blast. Running Lunatic Fringe on a modern computer has been a challenge. Fringe Player by Greg Parker filled this need during Apple?s PPC and Intel era, but is not supported on modern Apple platforms. Lunacy brings Lunatic Fringe to the present: a native Swift app with a built-in emulation engine that runs the original module, unchanged, on modern Apple platforms. Lunatic Fringe is one of my all-time favorite classic Mac games. Lunacy is a great modern player, including CRT simulation to make the game look a lot more like it did back in the day. ?

10. Pseudopocalypse

Source: DYNOMIGHT | Published: 2026-07-14T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://dynamight.net/pseudopocalypse/>

Here?s a conjecture: If you put any significant amount of text on the internet under different names, those identities can be linked using only the text itself. This is possible (I conject) because of the statistical ?fingerprint? you leave in everything you write. Imagine a website where you can paste in some brand-new text someone just wrote. In return, the website provides links to all the text that writer has ever published under any name. It?s not perfect, but it?s pretty good. As far as I know, no such website exists?at least not on the public internet. But I suspect it?s possible and will soon become easy. This will pose some difficulty for pseudonymous blogging. Note : I wrote most of this essay in mid-2025, after which I idiotically sat on it for a year tinkering with theorem statements that none of you will read. 1 In the meantime, LLMs have gotten much better at guessing authors from text. (Given the first 1000 words of a draft of this post, Claude 4.8 knows it?s me.) Still, I think we?re just getting started. I expect to see increasingly obscure writers identified from increasingly small bits of text. I expect that this work even when people are writing in a different...

11. Microspeak: Double-click and drill down

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260714-00/?p=112532>

Please, tell me more. The post Microspeak: Double-click and drill down appeared first on The Old New Thing .

12. The Tower Keeps Rising

Source: Armin Ronacher?s Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-07-13T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/7/13/the-tower-keeps-rising/>

I feel that some vibecoded software changes somewhat randomly and unexpectedly. That made me think about Bruegel?s ?The Tower of Babel? which shows an already quite chaotic depiction of the Tower of Babel. The story is usually told as one about pride and ambition and ultimately why people no longer speak the same language. But it is also a story about the unity that makes technological progress work. The text begins with a technology upgrade: And they said one to another, Go to, let us make brick, and burn them thoroughly. And they had brick for stone, and slime had they for mortar. They use it for a civilizational project: let us build us a city and a tower, whose top may reach unto heaven But when God assesses the situation the bricks are not what concern him: the people is one, and they have all one language, [?] and now nothing will be restrained from them. 1 The source of their power is coordination. They share a language and

with that shared language they can combine their work into something no one of them could build alone. God does not take away the bricks or their knowledge of how to make them. He takes away their ability to understand one another, and construction stops...

13. ICD-10 chapters and code letters

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 14:24:12 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/07/14/icd-10-chapters-letters/>

I've been thinking about ICD-10 codes; they come up a lot in my work. The ICD-10-CM standard is divided into 21 chapters, which generally correspond to the first letter of a code. However, a chapter may contain blocks beginning with more than one letter, and codes starting with a single letter, namely D, can span [?] The post ICD-10 chapters and code letters first appeared on John D. Cook .

14. Presigned URLs are technically a security vuln

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://www.tigrisdata.com/blog/presigned-urls-security-vuln/>

A presigned URL is a replay attack you did on purpose. Replayable auth tokens are the textbook way to create vulnerable systems, but Tigris ships them as a first-class feature with presigned URLs and so does every other object storage system on the planet. However this isn't an oversight because presigned URLs turn a weakness into a feature. Replay attacks are a real problem and the classic fix is miserable When you authenticate a request with Amazon's SigV4 protocol for Tigris, your client boils down the request to a canonical form: a SHA256 hash of the request's method, path, query parameters, signed headers and a SHA256 hash of the payload. It runs the result of that through HMAC with a signing key derived from your secret access key. Nothing secret ever crosses the wire. The server derives the same key as the client, does the same canonical form transformation, and compares the result. Being able to make a valid signature proves that the request came from someone holding the secret access key, but it proves nothing about when that request was made. A signature that was made a year ago would still be valid today or any other time you send it, so in theory an attacker could ware...

15. You should probably check on your smart appliances

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/notes/2026/check-your-smart-tv/>

TL;DR: is your refrigerator running malware? If so, you better catch it!

16. I'm a USB-C Maximalist

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 11:34:26 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/07/im-a-usb-c-maximalist/>

My wife and I recently went on a 7 week holiday around Europe. Although we each took a massive backpack, we wanted to travel fairly lightly. I took a single universal power brick. This little unit was all I needed to charge my various gadgets. It has a hefty USB-C PD (Power Delivery) port for rapid charging of my phone and laptop. Two other USB-C ports for my other gadgets. And a couple of?

17. I'm still alive

Source: Computer Things | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 16:15:07 +0000

Link: <https://buttondown.com/hillelwayne/archive/im-still-alive/>

(No summary)

18. Intuition for distribution differences

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/distribution-differences>

Imagine every person in a country is assigned some sort of score, and a higher score is better. I can't share the specifics around the score I'm investigating right now, but on the population level it is collected by a government agency. Here's the distribution of these scores for the

population in my country. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

19. Notes on the Fourier Transform

Source: Eli Bendersky's website | Published: 2026-07-14T20:04:00-07:00

Link: <https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/notes-on-the-fourier-transform/>

The Fourier series is a great tool for analyzing periodic functions. But what about functions that don't repeat? We've seen that we can compute Fourier series for a non-periodic function defined on a finite interval, as long as we don't care about its behavior beyond that interval ?

20. Jurassic Park computers in excruciating detail

Source: Fabien Sanglard | Published: 13 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: https://fabiansanglard.net/jurassic_park_computers/index.html

(No summary)

21. A dock that finally wakes up reliably

Source: Fabien Sanglard | Published: 11 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://fabiansanglard.net/tb4/index.html>

(No summary)

22. Don't you mean extinct?

Source: Fabien Sanglard | Published: 10 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://fabiansanglard.net/extinct/index.html>

(No summary)

23. Weekly Update 512: IoT Lockout Fail

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Wed, 15 Jul 2026 00:35:38 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-512/>

"Build a smart home", they said. "It'll make life so much better", they said. Well, life wasn't very bloody good at 23:00 the other night after travelling 33 hours from Paris only to find the IoT doorlock batteries dead and the

24. Pluralistic: Gerontocracy's failure mode (14 Jul 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 11:10:45 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/07/14/designated-survivor/>

Today's links Gerontocracy's failure mode: Where are the designated survivors? Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: MSFT v MP3; UK industry v schoolkids; Gary Larson v comics sharing; Planned LED obsolescence; PoGo v Black neighborhoods; Gnarlier trolley problems; Royal Society v cryptographic backdoors; Theresa May v climate change; Google v search; Facebook v facts. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest.

Gerontocracy's failure mode (permalink) The "designated survivor" is one of the weirder aspects of America's (very, very weird) political system. Each year, during the State of the Union address, when both houses of Congress and the President are all under one roof, a single political figure, in the line of succession for the presidency, is spirited away to a hidden bunker, just in case the US legislative and administrative branches are decapitated in a single, spectacular terrorist strike: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Designated_survivor Initia...